

Complete all steps in the process to prepare for your Presentation and Oral Defense (POD) and to submit your final Academic Paper. Be prepared to show proof of all of the steps you check off as completed.

Both the academic paper submission and the POD must be completed **before** 4/30/26 in order to be assigned a score by CollegeBoard. **Please submit your paper by 4/29/26 to avoid any issues.** Presentations will be in class on 4/20 - 4/23.

Steps to prepare your POD

☒ **Plan for POD**

- ☒ ~~Create an outline or complete a graphic organizer to plan for your presentation.~~
- ☒ ~~Respond to at least 3 Oral Defense Questions in writing.~~

☒ **Create slides**

- ☒ ~~A. Your slides should touch on all of the following:~~
 - i. Identifying your research question and project goal.
 - ii. describing and explaining initial assumptions and hypotheses/ideas and their relation to your personal conclusion.
 - iii. providing the rationale for choices made during the research process (cite or attribute sources or evidence as needed)
 - iv. explaining the research process/method, evidence generated, conclusions, and implications.
 - v. engaging the audience through a dynamic use of design, delivery, and performance techniques using a medium and design specifically tailored to engage your audience and illustrate your points.
- ☒ ~~B. Your slides use images to help convey your message. For example:~~
- ☒ ~~C. You practiced and timed yourself. How many times: 4~~

Steps to an Effective Academic paper submission This is not a quick process!!

☒ ~~You used an authorial voice by:~~

- a. Using language accessible to a non-subject specific scholar
- b. Providing definitions to terms and subject specific words. For example:
- c. Explaining and citing any complex concepts taken from your sources.
- d. Providing some type of written attribution in your voice as you introduce the work of others throughout the paper.
- e. Provide an explanation for all decisions made throughout the research process.
- f. Include rich description and analysis to justify your analysis, conclusions, and the significance of the work.

Citation and style guide adherence

- ☒ ~~Includes a cover page~~
- ☒ ~~Consistent citations and attribution~~
 - a. Written attribution

b. In-text parenthetical citations

☒ Edited and double-checked Reference list. How many sources? _____

☒ Consistent formatting of headings

a. Consistent with Style Guide heading levels

b. Headings are clear, concise, and effective

https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/apa_headings_and_serialization.html

☒ Consistent labeling of figures, tables, graphs as well as written references in the narrative of your paper (say in the paper according to the graph...).

https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/apa_tables_and_figures.html

☒ Pages are numbered

☒ **Mandated redactions** – The process of omitting or covering specific information to increase anonymity.

a. Content with

i. Your name

ii. School name

iii. Participant names (use pseudonyms)

b. Options for redaction

i. Avoid usage all together

ii. Cover specific items with black highlighting

☒ **Word count**

a. Range 4,000 - 5,000 words. How many words? 4610

b. Include on the coverpage or first page

c. Items that do not count in your word count

i. Graphs

ii. Data tables

iii. Images

iv. Appendices

v. Abstract

vi. Bibliography

☒ **PDF formatting – Before uploading to the Digital Portfolio:**

a. Convert your academic paper to a PDF

b. Open and check every part of your academic paper in PDF form

c. Things to check multiple times:

i. Images, graphs, and tables are still formatted correctly

ii. No blank pages are present

iii. No distortions throughout the paper

iv. Reference pages are still clear

v. Appendix formatting is still correct

☒ **Originality Report** – This is a crucial step to protect your score and reputation as a researcher.

- a. Run an originality report through Turnitin available in the Digital Portfolio. What was your originality score? 15%
- b. Use the report to check your citations one last time.
- c. If you change anything you will need to submit a new PDF and redo the pdf formatting steps.

☒ **~~Submit the paper by 4/29/26~~**

- a. Submit Paper as final. Be sure to upload the most recent and fully checked draft of your paper.
- b. Move through a series of prompts
 - i. Read these prompts carefully
 - ii. Once submitted, send an email to the teacher (Me), I can check to make sure it is truly submitted.
 - iii. Celebrate!!

AFTER Submission

☒ **~~Reflect in your researcher journal~~**